



Arch Linux 2009.08 introduces kernel 2.6.30

Arch Linux release engineer, Dieter Plaetinck, has announced the release of the project's official 2009.08 installation images. The new version features the 2.6.30.4 Linux kernel (which brings in support for ext4 filesystem) and version 3.3.0 of its Pacman package manager.

In addition to a wide variety of bug fixes, boot device detection has been enhanced and Aufs2 (advanced multi-layered unification filesystem version 2) replaces the

UnionFS used in previous versions. The AIF (Arch Linux Installation Framework) installer also includes several updates, adding support for automated installations using config files, better date/time setting with NTP, various usability improvements and a new framework for users to build their own installation procedures.

ChromeDevTools for Eclipse users

Google software engineer Alexander Pavlov has announced the release of ChromeDevTools for Eclipse users. ChromeDevTools enables JavaScript debugging inside the browser over the TCP/IP-based ChromeDevToolsProtocol using Eclipse and consists of two components: an SDK and a debugger.

The SDK includes a Java API to enable communication over TCP/IP with Google Chrome or its Chromium counterpart. The debugger, a plug-in for Eclipse that uses the SDK, lets developers debug JavaScript running within Chrome from the Eclipse IDE. Using ChromeDevTools, developers can inspect variables, set breakpoints and evaluate expressions. ChromeDevTools requires version 3.4.2 or later of Eclipse and Google Chrome or Chromium version 3.0.189.0 or later. ChromeDevTools is released under a New BSD Licence.

Perl 6 due in the spring of 2010

In a recent entry on his blog, Patrick Michaud has again confirmed the news that has been circulating for a while — that Perl 6 will be released in the spring of 2010 (with all of the signs pointing to April). Michaud is the 'Pumpkin' (keeper of the pumpkin patches—or release manager) for the Rakudo Perl 6 compiler, designed to run on the Parrot virtual machine.

The new spring version of the Perl scripting language will not include all of its functions, but it will be useable. According to Michaud, the release will be called 'Rakudo *' (Rakudo Star). Michaud says that language development is more of an 'evolutionary process' resulting from the interplay of language development and implementation efforts.

Rakudo Star will be released as version 1.0 in spring 2010, and the developers hope that the 1.0 tag will signify to users that, while it may not be complete, it is a usable implementation of Perl 6.

OpenGL 3.2 specification released

The Khronos Group has announced OpenGL 3.2, the third major update in 12 months to the most widely adopted 2D and 3D graphics API for personal computers and workstations. This new release continues the rapid evolution of the OpenGL standard to enable graphics developers to access cutting-edge GPU functionality across diverse operating systems and platforms. The full specification is available for immediate download at www.opengl.org/registry.

OpenGL 3.2 adds features for enhanced performance, increased visual quality, accelerated geometry processing and easier portability of Direct3D applications. In addition, OpenGL and other standards within Khronos, including OpenCL for parallel compute, OpenGL ES for mobile 3D graphics and the new WebGL standard for 3D on the Web, are being coordinated to create a powerful graphics and compute ecosystem that spans many applications markets and devices. The installed base of OpenGL 3.2 compatible GPUs already exceeds 150 million units.

Scribus 1.3.5 introduced

Following many testing cycles in the past two years, the Scribus Team has finally announced the release of Scribus 1.3.5. The team considers this version to be fairly stable and ready for many real-world use cases. As proof, the cover of the Official Scribus Manual has been created with a release candidate of 1.3.5. While there are still a few chinks and bugs in the latest version, the team will continue to implement new features and improvements in a new experimental branch. Once tested and confirmed as working flawlessly, they will be backported and become part of the 1.4 milestone.

Major changes in the latest release would be: a native OS X version (available as a .dmg file), based on Qt 4, drag and drop improvements, optional embedding of PDF and EPS files, a new line editor for custom line styles and a lot more. Furthermore, about 1,100 feature requests and bugs, both large and small, have been resolved.

